March 2026: Playtest Packet

This document contains playtest material for the Dungeons of Drakkenheim: Daggerheart project.

This Playtest Pack includes a selection of new and revised rules to support playing the Dungeons of Drakkenheim adventure using the Daggerheart tabletop roleplaying game.

The game rules provided herein are not finalized and are subject to change. Ghostfire's design team will conduct a development review, taking into account playtest feedback, before proceeding with a formal editing pass to create the final form of these rules.

Providing Feedback

If you would like to playtest these preliminary designs and provide your feedback, please use the following link to fill out the survey:

Playtest Feedback Link

The deadline for providing playtest feedback for this playtest packet is:

11:59 pm AEDT, April 20th, 2026.

What's Included

This playtest packet includes the following:

DAGGERHEART RULE ADJUSTMENTS

- **Gold**
  A variant wealth scale for the Dungeons of Drakkenheim
- **Contaminated Domain Cards**
  Creatures exposed to delirium may have access to contaminated variants of domain cards.
- **Mutations**
  Contamination can lead to mutations and new features.
- **Contaminated Death Moves**
  Significant mutations eventually transform creatures into horrific monsters. Players have a choice on how to spend their PC's last moments.
- **Contaminated Evolution**
  Progressive contamination can transform creatures into new variants.
- **Adversaries**
  A collection of Drakkenheim monsters.
- **Environments**
  A description of the Outer City and Emberwood Village.

ENCOUNTER AREA EXAMPLE

- **Rat's Nest Tavern**
  This encounter area from the original Dungeons of Drakkenheim translated for Daggerheart rules.

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Daggerheart Rule Adjustments

Gold in Drakkenheim

Dungeons of Drakkenheim uses its own scale for wealth instead of the scale in the Daggerheart core rulebook.

In this campaign guide, use the following denominations and conversions:
10 handfuls of gold = 1 bag of gold
10 bags of gold = 1 sack of gold
10 sacks of gold = 1 chest of gold

Contaminated Domain Cards

Drakkenheim is host to many strange and terrifying powers – unheard of magics, warped weaves of reality, and more. PCs who engage with the city and its dangers can gain access to Contaminated domain cards, powerful variants of the standard domain cards.

Every domain has several contaminated domain cards, each a variation on a standard domain card. When you gain a contaminated domain card, you can add it to your loadout or your Vault. From then on, it operates as any other domain card, with the following exception: You cannot have both a contaminated and un-contaminated version of a domain card in your loadout at the same time. One of the two must always be in your Vault, though you can recall one and vault the other when you do so.

Here are a few core options for how you might gain access to Contaminated Domain cards, but you should decide what approach makes sense for your game. Gaining contaminated domain cards should not be easy, but players that seek them should be able to acquire them, given enough time and effort.

Surviving Contamination

Contamination can be purged, but something happens to a soul and mind when it comes close to the edge. Delerium's power leaves a mark on you, unlocking new avenues for power.

When you reach contamination level 3 or higher and then purge your contamination entirely, you can gain access to a contaminated domain card from one of your domains, up to tier 3.
When you reach contamination level 5 and then purge your contamination entirely, you can gain access to a contaminated domain card up to tier 4. You cannot learn a contaminated domain card above your level, but once you have survived contamination level 5 and come back from the brink, you can gain a tier 4 contaminated domain card later when you reach the appropriate level.
When you gain access to a contaminated domain card, you might gain the card immediately upon purging contamination, you might gain it when you next level up, or you might gain it in a dramatic situation when you need to push yourself to the limit.

Learning from NPCs

Characters who have survived extended exposure to Delerium manifest incredible powers, and some of those NPCs can be convinced to share what they have learned with PCs.

Here are some NPCs you might consider for teachers that can pass on knowledge of contaminated domain cards, arranged by domain. You might also consider creating specific NPCs associated with factions that the PCs have a good relationship with, especially if other options for the relevant domains don't make sense for your party or your version of Drakkenheim.

- **Blade, Bone, Valor.** The Ironhelm siblings, Ansom and Petra Lang
- **Sage, Midnight.** Old Zoya, Eoghan Ghostweaver
- **Arcana, Codex.** Oscar Yoren, the Pale Man
- **Grace, Splendor.** Ryan Greymire, the Duchess, the Queen of Thieves

An NPC may ask for a favor or task from the PC before agreeing to teach them, and learning contaminated domain cards from NPCs should probably take the form of a Long-Term Project. The higher the level of the contaminated card, the longer the project. Additionally, learning these powerful abilities may be dangerous on its own or require the PC to face dangers in order to access the greater power.
Manuals, Spellbooks, and other Artifacts

Perhaps the powerful variations on domain abilities existed before the meteor, or maybe these techniques can be learned from a text and not just from a living teacher in-person. Characters might stumble upon contaminated spell cards or grimoires in a NPCs' spellbook, like that of Oscar Yoren or Ryan Greymire. Perhaps a warrior from a past delved into the city survived long enough to write down the techniques they developed and their manual survives long after they succumbed to the city's dangers.

Arcana Domain

Delerium Grasp
Contaminated Spell
Arcana 2 – Cinder Grasp
Recall Cost: 1

Make a Spellcast Roll against a target within Melee range. On a success, **give the GM a Fear** to have the target instantly burst into eldritch flames, taking **d12+3** magic damage using your proficiency and become temporarily *Consumed by Octarine Flame*. If the target takes Severe damage from this attack, they must mark a Stress or gain 1 Contamination Level.

When a creature acts while *Consumed by Octarine Flame*, they must take an additional 2d6 magic damage and mark a Stress if they are still *Consumed by Octarine Flame* at the end of their action.

Delerium Premonition
Contaminated Spell
Arcana 5 – Premonition
Recall Cost: 2

You can channel eldritch energy to have visions of the future. At the end of a long rest, **give the GM a number of Fear** up to your tier and add that number of tokens to this card. Immediately after the GM conveys the consequences of a roll you made, you can spend a token and rescind the move and the consequences like they never happened and make another move instead.

Eldritch Reflection
Contaminated Spell
Arcana 8 – Arcane Reflection
Recall Cost: 1

When you would take damage, **give the GM any number of Fear** and roll that many d6s. If any roll 4, the damage is reflected back to the attacker, dealing the damage to them instead.

Conjure Meteor
Contaminated Spell
Arcana 10 – Falling Sky
Recall Cost: 1

Make a Spellcast Roll against all targets within Far range. Give the GM any number of Fear to make delerium meteors rain down from above. Targets you succeed against take **1d20+5** magic damage for each Fear given to the GM, and must make a Presence Reaction Roll (**12+the number of Fear given**) or gain 2 levels of contamination.

Blade Domain

Uncanny Focus
Contaminated Ability
Blade 4 – Deadly Focus
Recall Cost: 2

Once per rest, you can apply otherworldly focus toward a target of your choice. Until you attack another creature, you defeat your target, or the battle ends, gain a +1 bonus to your Proficiency. When you force the target to mark HP, **you can give the GM a Fear** to force the target to mark an additional HP.

Delerium Rage
Contaminated Ability
Blade 6 – Rage Up
Recall Cost: 1

Before you make an attack, **give the GM a Fear** to gain a bonus to your damage roll equal to three times your Strength**. If you additionally gain a level of contamination**, this damage bonus lasts until the end of the scene.

Octarine Onslaught
Contaminated Ability
Blade 10 – Onslaught
Recall Cost: 3

When you successfully make an attack with your weapon, you never deal damage beneath a target's Major damage threshold (the target always marks a minimum of 2 Hit Points).

Additionally, when a creature within your weapon's range deals damage to an ally with an attack that doesn't include you, **you can give the GM a Fear** to force them to make a Reaction Roll (15). On a failure, the target must mark **1d4** Hit Points. If you additionally gain a level of Contamination, the target automatically fails the Reaction Roll and must mark **2d4** Hit Points instead.

Bone Domain

Octarine Brace
Contaminated Ability
Bone 3 – Brace
Recall Cost: 1

When you mark an Armor Slot to reduce incoming damage, **give the GM a Fear** to mark any number of additional Armor Slots.

Eldritch Recovery
Contaminated Ability
Bone 6 – Recovery
Recall Cost: 1

During a short rest, you can choose one long rest downtime move instead. Choose any number of allies and **give the GM a Fear for each** to let the targets also choose one long rest downtime move instead.

Unkillable
Contaminated Ability
Bone 9 – On the Brink
Recall Cost: 1

When you have 2 or fewer Hit Points unmarked and take damage, **you can give the GM a Fear** to become *Undaunted* until the end of the scene. While *Undaunted*, you don't take Minor or Major damage.

When you would mark your last HP, **you can take a level of contamination** instead of marking HP.

Codex Domain

Octarine Wall
Contaminated Spell
Codex 5 – Manifest Wall
Recall Cost: 2

Make a **Spellcast Roll (14)**. Once per rest on a success, **give the GM a Fear** to create a temporary wall of octarine magic between two points within Far range. It can be up to 50 feet high and form at any angle. Creatures or objects in its path gain a level of contamination and are shunted to a side of your choice.

A creature that touches the wall must make a **Reaction Roll (14)** or take **d12** magic damage using your Proficiency. The wall stays up until your next rest or you cast **Octarine Wall** again.

Book of Yoren
Contaminated Grimoire
Codex 3 – Book of Norai
Recall Cost: 2

Eldritch Tether/Warp Bolt: Make a **Spellcast Roll** against a target within Far range. On a success, they're temporarily *Restrained* and *Vulnerable* and must mark a Stress. If you target a flying creature, the spell grounds and temporarily *Restrains* them. If you give the GM a Fear, the target also suffers **d10** magic damage using your Proficiency.

Octarine Fireball: Make a Spellcast Roll against a target within Very Far range. On a success, **give the GM 2 Fear** to hurl a sphere of octarine fire toward them that explodes on impact. The target and all creatures within Close range must make a **Reaction Roll (15)**. Targets who fail take **d20+10** magic damage using your proficiency and gain a level of contamination. Targets who succeed take half damage but mark a Stress.

Delerium Wave
Contaminated Spell
Codex 9 – Disintegration Wave
Recall Cost: 4

Make a **Spellcast Roll (16)**. Once per long rest on a success, the GM tells you which adversaries within Far range have a Difficulty of 18 or lower. Give the GM a Fear for each one you wish to hit with this spell. They are killed and can't come back to life by any means. If you additionally take a level of contamination, they are killed and transformed into delerium formations of the same size (but can't be transformed back).

Grace Domain

Otherworldly Shimmer

Contaminated Spell
Grace 3 – Hypnotic Shimmer
Recall Cost: 1

Make a Spellcast Roll against all adversaries in front of you within Close range. Once per rest on a success, create an illusion of otherworldly colors and lights that temporarily *Enthralls* targets you succeed against. While *Enthralled*, they cannot use reactions and cannot take any other actions until they clear the condition. **You can give the GM a Fear** to make an *Enthralled* target mark **1d4** Stress, once per target.

Eldritch Discord

Contaminated Spell
Grace 5 – Words of Discord
Recall Cost:

Whisper words of discord to an adversary within Melee range and make a Spellcast Roll (13). On a success, the target must mark a Stress and make an attack against another adversary instead of against you or your allies.

Once this attack is over, the target realizes what happened. The next time you cast Eldritch Discord on them, gain a -5 penalty to the Spellcast Roll. **You can give the GM 2 Fear** to ignore this penalty.

Octarine Mimicry

Contaminated Spell
Grace 9 – Copycat
Recall Cost: 3

Once per long rest, this card can mimic the features of another domain card of level 8 or lower in another player's loadout. Give the GM Fear equal to half the card's level to again access to the feature. It lasts until your next rest or they place the card in your Vault. When you would lose this ability, you may gain a level of contamination to extend this ability until the end of your next rest.

Midnight Domain

Eldritch Spirit

Contaminated Spell
Midnight 2 – Midnight Spirit
Recall Cost: 1

Give the GM a Fear to summon a humanoid-sized spirit that can move or carry things for you until your next rest.

You can also send it to attack an adversary. When you do, make a **Spellcast Roll** against a target within Very Far range. On a success, the spirit moves into Melee range with the target. Roll a number of **d8s** equal to your Spellcast trait and deal that much damage to the target. The spirit then dissipates unless you **give the GM a Fear**. You can only have one spirit at a time.

Uncanny Retreat

Contaminated Spell
Midnight 5 – Phantom Retreat
Recall Cost: 2

Give the GM a Fear to activate Uncanny Retreat where you're currently standing. Mark a Stress at any time before your next rest to disappear from where you are and reappear where you were when you activated Phantom Retreat. If you teleported into the haze from outside of it, or from outside of the haze into it, gain a level of contamination. The spell ends after you reappear.

Delerium Toll

Contaminated Spell
Midnight 9 – Twilight Toll
Recall Cost: 1

Choose a target within Far range. When you succeed on an action roll against them that doesn't result in making a damage roll, place a token on this card. When you deal damage to this target, give the GM a Fear and spend any number of tokens to add a d20 for each token spent to your damage roll. You can only hold **Octarine Toll** on one creature at a time.

When you choose a new target or take a rest, you can take a level of contamination. If you don't, clear all unspent tokens.

Sage Domain

Contaminated Swarm

Contaminated Spell
Sage 2 – Conjure Swarm
Recall Cost: 1

***Chitinous Pests*: Mark a Stress** to conjure contaminated beetles and armored pests that encircle you: When you next take damage, reduce the severity by one threshold. **You can give the GM a Fear** to keep the pests conjured after taking damage.

Eldritch Fireflies: Make a Spellcast Roll against all adversaries within Close range. **Give the GM a Fear** to deal 2d12+3 magic damage to targets you succeed against.

Unnatural Surge

Contaminated Spell
Sage 7 – Wild Surge
Recall Cost: 2

Once per long rest, **give the GM 2 Fear** to channel contaminated nature around you and enhance yourself. Describe how your appearance changes, then place a **d6** on this card with the 1 value facing up.

While the Unnatural Surge Die is active, you add its value to every Duality Dice or damage roll you make. After you add its value to a roll, increase the Unnatural Surge Die's value by 1. When the die's value would exceed 6 or you take a rest, this form drops and you take a level of contamination.

Locus of Contamination

Contaminated Ability
Sage 9 – Fane of the Wilds
Recall Cost: 2

After a long rest, **give the GM 2 Fear** and place a number of tokens equal to the number of contaminated domain cards in your loadout and vault on this card.

When you would make an Action Roll, you can spend any number of tokens after the roll to gain a +1 bonus for each token spent. When you critically succeed on a Spellcast Roll, gain a token.

When you take a long rest, clear all unspent tokens and make a Presence Reaction Roll. On a failure, gain a level of contamination.

Splendor Domain

Stolen Vigor

Contaminated Ability
Splendor 3 – Second Wind
Recall Cost: 2

Once per rest, when you succeed on an attack against an adversary, you can clear 3 Stress or a Hit Point, and give the GM up to 2 Fear (you can give 0):

1 Fear: the target must mark an additional Hit Point and you instead clear 3 Stress **and** a Hit Point.
2 Fear: Also clear 3 Stress and a Hit Point from an ally within Close range of you.

Eldritch Smite

Contaminated Spell
Splendor 5 – Smite
Recall Cost: 2

Once per rest, **give the GM 2 Fear** to charge your powerful smite. When you next successfully attack with a weapon, double the result of your damage roll and force the target to mark 2 Stress. This attack deals magic damage regardless of the weapon's damage type.

Cruel Salvation

Contaminated Spell
Splendor 10 – Resurrection
Recall Cost: 2

Make a Spellcast Roll (20). On a success, target a willing person with zero levels of contamination within Close and **give the GM 6 Fear** to remove all contamination from a person who has undergone a Monstrous Transformation and return their self-control. The willing person gains all those levels of contamination and instantly undergoes a Monstrous Transformation.

On a failure, you cannot cast this spell again for a week.

Valor Domain

Unearthly Presence

Contaminated Ability
Valor 2 – Bold Presence
Recall Cost: 0

When you make a Presence Roll, you can **mark a Stress** to add your Strength to the Roll. If you roll a failure, you can **give the GM a Fear** to re-roll and take the new result. Additionally, once per rest when you would gain a condition, you can describe how your bold presence aids you in the situation and avoid gaining the condition.

Octarine Endurance

Contaminated Ability
Valor 7 – Shrug it Off
Recall Cost: 1

When you would take damage, you can **give the GM a Fear** to reduce the severity of the damage by one threshold.

None Shall Pass

Contaminated Ability
Valor 9 – Hold the Line
Recall Cost: 1

Describe the defensive stance you take and **give the GM a Fear**. If an adversary moves within Close range, they're pulled into Melee and *Restrained*.

This stance lasts until you move, fail a roll with Fear, or the next sunrise. You may choose to gain a level of contamination to prevent this stance from ending.

Mutations

Creatures with delirium contamination may manifest additional features.

Belly Maw

A toothy mouth appears on your stomach.

Belly Bite: When you succeed on an attack against a target within Melee range, you can **mark a Stress** to bite the target, dealing an extra **2d4** physical damage.

Lashing Tongue: If you have Contamination Level 4 or higher, **Give the GM a Fear** to make a target within Very Close range temporarily *Restrained* and *Vulnerable*.

What awful flavors does this maw crave? What does it feel like to be hungry all the time even as you feed your normal mouth?

Spatial Displacement

You are partially phased-out of this plane of existence. All sensations are hazy and muted.

Delerium Step: You may **mark a Stress** to teleport up to Close range. If you immediately make an attack, add a bonus equal to your Contamination Level.

Phased Out: If you have Contamination Level 4 or higher, **give the GM a Fear** to halve incoming physical damage.

How do you feel about always being out of sync with the rest of the world? What do you smell, taste, hear, or feel from the realm beyond while you touch it?

Spiked Growths

Numerous spine or horn-like growths emerge from your body.

Spined: When you are hit by an attack from within Melee range, you may **mark a Stress** to force the attacker to suffer **1d10+2** physical damage.

Porcupine: If you have contamination level 4 or higher, you gain disadvantage on Finesse rolls. You can **give the GM a Fear** to make a Strength attack at Melee range. On a success, deal **d10** physical damage using your proficiency and make the target temporarily *Bleeding*. While *Bleeding*, they suffer **1d12** physical damage whenever they take the spotlight.

What everyday activities are difficult or impossible without assistance now that you have these growths? Which of your favorite clothes are ruined or unwearable in this state?

Chitinous Skin

Shell-like growths appear all over your body.

Armored Skin: You gain a +1 bonus to your armor score. At the end of each rest, if all of your armor slots are marked, clear one armor slot.

Carapace: If you have Contamination Level 4 or higher, you gain a -1 to Finesse. When you suffer damage, you can **give the GM a Fear** to reduce the severity by one threshold.

How do you feel sensation on these growths differently, or do you not feel anything at all? How does your center of balance change? How do your clothes fit, or do you have to wear different ones?

Contaminated Death Moves

A creature who reaches contamination level 6 or higher triggers a transformation into a horrific monster controlled by the Game Master. But a player has a choice on how to spend their PC's last moments of control, selecting a Contaminated Death Move.

Once triggered, work with the GM in selecting one of the following Contaminated Death Moves. These work like the normal Death Moves in Daggerheart, but they are triggered by contamination rather than marking your last HP. If you would make a normal death move during a contaminated death move, resolve it as normal, but no death moves can save you from contamination.

- ***Test of Will***: You attempt to maintain control long enough to finish what you started. Roll your Duality Dice.
  - If the Hope Die is higher, you may make one Action Roll that automatically critically succeeds (with GM approval), then you lose control forever.
  - If the Fear Die is higher, the GM gains Fear equal to half the number rolled, then takes the spotlight as you immediately turn on your allies. On a critical success,
  - On a critical, you are able to maintain control for the rest of the scene, at which point you charge off into the distance. If you die before the end of the scene, you immediately return as a Haze Wight.
- ***Mercy Kill***: You call out to your friends to kill you before you can hurt them. Move up to a Close distance to an ally, who puts you out of your misery. All PCs within Far lose all Hope.
- ***Into the Haze***: Afraid of hurting your friends, you use what self-control you have left to charge off into the Haze. The GM will be able to use your transformed character as an adversary in the future. The GM gains a number of Fear equal the transformed character's tier.

When a PC transforms, the Game Master chooses the transformed PC's new monstrous form, which is most often something like a delerium dreg or haze hulk. The new form usually has a Tier similar to that of the original PC, but under appropriate circumstances you can choose one that is higher or lower (a level 4 PC becoming a Tier 3 adversary, for instance). The adversary's game statistics are entirely replaced by those of the chosen monster. All contamination levels are removed, though the GM may grant additional features to the new form similar to any beneficial mutations gained from contamination levels.

The GM determines what remains of the original creature's personality and memories, if anything. Regardless, if the creature survives the Death Move, the GM takes full control over the former PC.

A transformed former PC makes for an excellent rival or recurring foil. Consider having the monstrous character retain their intelligence and most of their personality, but twisted in some way beyond humanoid reason.

Contaminated Evolution

Continued exposure to the haze causes progressive mutation. Ratlings, dregs, haze hulks, and other adversaries continue to change into ever-stranger, more dangerous variations over time, sometimes shifting between the loose categories of monstrosity known to the uncontaminated.

The following GM move is available at any time within the Haze.

Spontaneous Evolution – Action: Spend a number of Fear to transform a Standard or Minion adversary with the Contaminated type into another adversary in the same group (Delerium Dreg to Delerium Dreg, Ratling to Ratling). The cost depends on the transformation:

- 2 Fear – Transform into a Bruiser, Standard, Ranged, Standard, Support, or Skulk adversary of the same tier.
- 4 Fear – Transform into a Leader or Solo adversary of the same tier.
- 6 Fear – Transform into a Bruiser, Standard, Ranged, Standard, Support, or Skulk adversary at the adversary's Tier +1.
- 8 Fear – Transform into a Leader or Solo adversary at the adversary's Tier +1

Adversaries

Adversaries with the Contaminated type are immune to gaining levels of contamination and gain advantage against Reaction Rolls generated by contaminated domain cards.

HAZE HUSK

Tier 1 Contaminated Minion

The walking dead with agonized looks upon its face and shards of delerium protruding from its skin.

Motives & Tactics: Slay the living, maul, surround

Difficulty: 8 | **Thresholds:** None | **HP:** 1 | **Stress:** 1
ATK: -3 | Bit: Melee | 2 phy

FEATURES

Minion (3) – Passive: The Husk is defeated when they take any damage. For every 3 damage a PC deals to the Husk, defeat an additional Minion within range the attack would succeed against.

Group Attack – Action: Spend a Fear to choose a target and spotlight all Haze Husks within Close range of them. Those Minions move into Melee range of the target and make one shared attack roll. On a success, they deal 2 physical damage each. Combine this damage.

Death Burst – Reaction: When 3 or more Husks are defeated at once, the combined explosions create a burst of contamination. All creatures within Very Close range must make an **Agility Reaction Roll (10)** or take **2d10** magic damage and gain a level of contamination.

HAZE WIGHT

Tier 1 Contaminated Leader

An undead warrior with purple stretched skin and dead eyes burning with spectral energy. Its broken armor reveals a deep gash, eldritch magic welling within the wound.

Motives & Tactics: Interpret the living as monsters, reanimate the dead, wreak havoc

Difficulty: 13 | **Thresholds:** 7/15 | **HP:** 6 | **Stress:** 3
ATK: +2 | Rusty Greatsword: Melee | 1d10+2 phy

FEATURES

Relentless (2)– Passive: Passive: Rat Prince can be spotlighted up to two times per GM turn. Spend Fear as usual to spotlight them.

Contaminated Blast - Action: Spend a Fear to make an attack against a target within Far. On a success, the target takes **2d8+2** magic damage and must make a Strength Reaction Roll or gain one level of contamination.

Animate Haze Husk - Action: Spend a Fear to raise two Haze Husks, which appear within Close. **You may spend an additional Fear** to immediately spotlight them and make a Group Attack.

Momentum - Reaction: When the Wight makes a successful attack against a PC, you gain a Fear.

DISHEVELED DREG

Tier 2 Contaminated Minion

A wretched being twisted by eldritch contamination. Beneath its torn clothing is purple-grey flesh marred by sores and bulging blood.

Motives & Tactics: Consume, destroy, grasp for shreds of memory

Difficulty: 13 | **Thresholds:** None | **HP:** 1 | **Stress:** 1
ATK: +1 | Claws: Melee | 5 phy

Experience: Tremore Sense +2

FEATURES

Minion (5) – Passive: The Dreg is defeated when they take any damage. For every 5 damage a PC deals to the Dreg, defeat an additional Minion within range the attack would succeed against.

Group Attack – Action: Spend a Fear to choose a target and spotlight all Disheveled Dregs within Close range of them. Those Minions move into Melee range of the target and make one shared attack roll. On a success, they deal 5 physical damage each. Combine this damage.

Corrupting Claws – Reaction: When a target marks HP from the Dreg's Group Attack, they must make a **Strength Reaction Roll** or gain one level of contamination.

WARP WITCH

Tier 2 Contaminated Standard

A corrupted spirit in ethereal robes gliding through the air, clutching a wrought iron lantern that glows in eldritch hues and green flames.

Motives & Tactics: contaminate the living, confound hosts' allies, grasp for shreds of memory, unleash terrifying scream

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 8/15 | **HP:** 8 | **Stress:** 3
ATK: +3 | Claws: Very Close | 1d12+2 phy

Experience: Malice +2, Dread Will +2

FEATURES

Ethereal - Passive: Warp Witch has resistance to physical damage and can **mark a Stress** to move through other creatures or objects.

Exorcism - Passive: The party can clear **Possessed** from a PC with a ritual of exorcism by completing a Progress Countdown (3). A *possessed* PC can describe how they fight the Witch for control and spend Hope to assist rolls to complete this countdown.

Mutate Host - Action: While the Warp Witch has a target *possessed*, **spend a Fear** to force the target to make a Presence Reaction Roll or gain a level of contamination. If a target *possessed* by the Witch makes a Contaminated Death Move, the Witch leaves the host, clearing *possessed*.

Possession - Action: Make an attack against a target within Melee. On a success, **mark a Stress** to force the target to make a Presence Reaction Roll. On a failure, gain 2 Fear as the Witch *possesses* the target. A *possessed* target cannot act on their own and are instead under the control of the Witch, but can mark a Stress to give the Witch disadvantage on an attack.

Reprieve – Reaction: When a PC clears *possessed*, the Witch appears in Melee range of their former target and the target cannot be *possessed* in this way until after their nest long rest.

RATLING PACK

Tier 2 Contaminated Horde (2/HP)

A scurrying mass of furry bodies in scrap clothing. Rodent-like claws brandish rust-caked blades, their many squeaking voices a cacophony of chittering.

Motives & Tactics: Avoid fair fights, scrounge for food & treasure, surround outnumbered foes

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 10/22 | **HP:** 5 | **Stress:** 3
ATK: +1 | Claws & Blades: Melee | 2d10+2 phy

Experience: Scavenger +2

FEATURES

Horde 2d6+1 – Passive: When the Pack has marked half or more of their HP, their standard attack deals **2d6+1** physical damage instead.

Courageous With Overwhelming Numbers – Passive: Ratling Pack has advantage on attacks against targets that do not have any allies within Very Close. On a success with such an attack, add **1d6** to the damage dealt (combine this damage).

Ratling Cunning – Reaction: When Ratling Pack takes damage, **mark a Stress** to move up to a Close distance in any direction.

RATLING GUTTERSNIPE

Tier 2 Contaminated Skulk

A cloaked ratling wielding a wicked blade carved from delerium. A hand crossbow hangs at their side with a quiver of poison-tipped bolts.

Motives & Tactics: Avoid fair fights, hit distracted foes, lay traps, reposition and hide, survive at all costs

Difficulty: 15 | **Thresholds:** 8/16 | **HP:** 3 | **Stress:** 3
ATK: +2 | Stolen Blades: Melee | 2d8+2 phy

Experience: Keen Senses +2, Stealth +2

FEATURES

Contaminated Blade – Passive: When a target marks HP from an attack by Guttersnipe, they must make an Agility Reaction Roll or gain a level of contamination.

Hit and Run – Passive: Guttersnipe can move up to a Close range after making an attack and become *Hidden* if they end their movement out of sight of any enemies.

Poisoned Crossbow – Action: Make an attack against a target within Far. On a success, the target takes **2d8+3** physical damage. If they mark HP, they become *Poisoned* until their next rest or they succeed on a **Knowledge Roll (15)**. While *Poisoned*, the target must roll a **d6** before they make an action roll. On a result of 4 or lower, they must mark a Stress.

Exploit Opening - Passive: If the Guttersnipe succeeds on a standard attack with advantage or if another Ratling was within Melee range of the target, gain a Fear and add **2d4** to their damage pool (combine this damage).

RATLING BURROW WARDEN

Tier 2 Contaminated Bruiser

This burly ratling stands a head taller than their broodlings, with a snarling snout and clad in scavenged bits of armor. They carry a rusted halberd and a broad, makeshift shield.

Motives & Tactics: Defend choke points, destroy and consume foes, protect smaller ratlings with improvised shield, throw their weight around

Difficulty: 13 | **Thresholds:** 13/26 | **HP:** 7 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +1 | Halberd: Very Close | 2d10+2 phy

Experience: Bully +2

FEATURES

Ramp Up – Passive: You must spend a Fear as an additional cost spotlight the Warden. While spotlighted, they can make their standard attack against all targets within range.

Shield Shove – Action: Make an attack against a target within Melee. On a success, the target takes **2d10+2** physical damage, is knocked back to Close range, and becomes *Vulnerable* until they next take the spotlight. If this movement pushes them into another creature or heavy object, they both take **1d6** physical damage (add this damage together).

Guard the Small – Reaction: When an ally within Melee is targeted by an attack, **mark a Stress** to give that roll disadvantage.

WARLOCK OF THE RAT GOD

Tier 2 Contaminated Leader

A small ratling cloaked in old rags carries a bone wand in one claw and a skull set with delerium shards in the other.

Motives & Tactics: Invoke the rat god, feed and grow stronger, use lesser ratlings as shields, swarm enemies

Difficulty: 15 | **Thresholds:** 11/23 | **HP:** 7 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +2 | Scavenged Wand: Close | 2d8+4 mag

Experience: Bully +2

FEATURES

Isolate Prey – Passive: All ratlings and rats within Very Close of the Warlock deal an additional **1d6** damage to targets that do not have any allies within Very Close range.

Summon the Swarm – Action: Once per scene, **spend a Fear** to summon a Swarm of Rats, which appears at a Close range and immediately takes the spotlight.

Invoke the Rat God – Action: **Spend 2 Fear** to spotlight up to 5 allies within Far range.

Your Life for Mine – Reaction: When Warlock would take damage, **mark a Stress** to make target ally within Very Close take the damage instead.

My Destiny Lies Elsewhere – Reaction: Once per session, when the Warlock would mark their last HP, **spend a Fear** to have them teleport up to a Far range instead.

SWARM OF RATS

Tier 1 Horde (5/HP)

A skittering mass of ordinary rodents moving as one like a ravenous wave.

Motives & Tactics: Consume, obscure, swarm

Difficulty: 10 | **Thresholds:** 6/10 | **HP:** 6 | **Stress:** 2
ATK: -3 | Bite: Melee | 1d8+2 phy

FEATURES

Horde (1d4+1)– Passive: Passive: When the Swarm has marked half or more of their HP, their standard attack deals 1d4+1 physical damage instead.

In Your Face – Passive: All targets within Melee range have disadvantage on attacks against targets other than the Swarm.

RAT PRINCE

Tier 2 Contaminated Solo

A larger ratling with black-brown fur and a wicked grin – some of his front teeth are delerium crystals. He wears scavenged bits of light armor, dark blue rags, and a gold crown which is slightly too small for his head.

Motives & Tactics: Eat to excess, fire contaminated bolts, grow stronger, slaughter humans

Difficulty: 16 | **Thresholds:** 12/25 | **HP:** 8 | **Stress:** 4
ATK: +3 | Blades and Bite: Melee | 2d10+4 phy

FEATURES

Relentless (2)– Passive: Passive: Rat Prince can be spotlighted up to two times per GM turn. Spend Fear as usual to spotlight them.

Contaminated Bite – Passive: Successful standard attacks inflict a level of contamination unless the target succeeds on an Agility Reaction Roll.

Prince Among Rats – Passive: Rat Prince gains advantage on attacks against targets in Melee with one or more Ratlings. Additionally, the Rat Prince can move up to a Very Close distance after making an attack.

Crossbow – Action: **Spend a Fear** to draw a crossbow and make an attack against a target within Far range. On a success, the target suffers **2d8+5** physical damage.

Protect Your Prince! – Reaction: When the Rat Prince would take damage, **mark a Stress** to force a target ratling within Close to take the damage instead.

Environments

DRAKKENHEIM: OUTER CITY

Tier 2 Exploration & Traversal

A ramshackle slum consisting of crumbling tenements, wattle and daub cottages, and fieldstone hovels.

Impulses: Entice the unready, conceal danger and opportunity

Difficulty: 13
Potential Adversaries: Delerium Dregs, Haze Husks, Ratlings (any)

FEATURES

The Haze - Passive: Whenever the party enters the haze for an expedition into the city, the GM should set an **Expedition Countdown (6 – Decreasing Loop)** that advances each time the party takes a short rest, spends a meaningful time in a location, or travels between two areas in the city.

Advance the countdown when the PCs:

- Travel between the Outer and Inner City
- Travel between locations
- Take a short rest
- Exert themselves in a battle or chase
- Spend a meaningful time in one place
- Longer journeys within the city may advance the countdown more than once.

When the countdown triggers, the characters must make a **Strength Reaction Roll** or gain a level of contamination. Once the Loop resets to zero, the PCs must make a **Strength Reaction Roll** every time the countdown would advance. On a failure, they gain a level of contamination. Clear the Expedition Countdown when the PCs take a Long Rest outside the haze.

What does the haze smell like? Does it obscure some items or beings more than others? What is the nearest landmark you can see above the haze?

Search the Ruins – Passive: If the party conducts a thorough search of an area (looking for: scavenged supplies, lost treasures, unknown locations, a hidden foe, or a safe place to rest), call for a Group Action Roll. Each such roll takes at least an hour (advance the Expedition Countdown).

- **Critical Success:** the party finds what they were looking for and something extra (loot, a clue related to another location, or something of value to a faction).
- **Success with Hope:** the party finds what they were looking for without additional complications.
- **Success with Fear:** the party finds what they were looking for, but must each mark a Stress.
- **Failure with Hope:** the party doesn't find what they were looking for, but they do find something else useful.
- **Failure with Fear:** the party fails to find what they were looking for and run afoul of adversaries or a major complication.

Treasure Hunter, *what signs of hidden wealth are you looking for? What kind of neighborhood is this? What signs of the factions or adversary groups can be found here?*

Endangered Pilgrims – Action: Reveal a group of pilgrims being attacked by Delerium Dregs or ratlings. Set a **Countdown (10)** representing the pilgrims, which advances when a pilgrim is killed. If the PCs defeat or scare off the attackers, ask a player to roll their Fear die. If the result is under the current value of the countdown, the PCs each gain a Hope and a minor favor from the Followers of the Falling Fire.

Missionary, *which of these pilgrims recognizes you as a person of faith, and what do you say to bolster their spirits?*

Wrong Turn – Reaction: On any failed roll to navigate or search the ruins, advance the Expedition Countdown as the party gets turned around traveling in circles and wasting time. You may additionally **spend a Fear** to introduce a new obstacle, threat, or group of adversaries.

What distracted or misled the PCs so that they didn't notice the problem right away? What creatures or faction agents are watching as the party travels in circles?

EMBERWOOD VILLAGE

Tier 2 Social

A humble village turned base camp and provisioning depot for travelers venturing into Drakkenheim. Amidst a bustling market square, a small crowd of adventurers, merchants, and prospectors busily traffic in all manner of weapons, equipment, coins, recovered treasures, and delerium.

Impulses: assemble fresh meat for the factions, provision adventurers, separate visitors from their money

Difficulty: 13
Potential Adversaries: Merchant, Jagged Knife Bandits (all), Hooded Lanterns (Bladed Guard, etc.)

FEATURES

Eclectic Assortment – Passive: Merchants in the Caravan Court have a shifting selection of wares, from staples like provisions, water, and adventuring equipment to specialized items and even some magical gear. If the party's acclaim is 6 or higher, they gain advantage on rolls interacting with merchants.

What strange item is on offer? What basic supplies or gear are currently out of stock?

Rumors Abound – Passive: When the party spends several hours in Emberwood Village, they will learn several rumors, a mix between old and new as well as a mix of truthful and misleading.

What's the talk of the town? Who is sharing the rumor, and what's their angle?

Rival Adventurers – Action: Introduce or spotlight a group of rival adventurers. They might taunt the PCs, they might allude to a mission they've just completed, they might overhear the PCs and try to beat them to the punch by getting to a site in the city first.

Who are these other adventurers? Which factions are they aligned with? What was their last trip into Drakkenheim like?

Look Who We Have Here – Action: **Spend 2 Fear** to introduce a group from a faction that dislikes the PCs (Relationship 4 or lower). The group antagonizes the PCs and might outright attack them if they think they can get away with it.

Which faction is it? What do they want from the interaction? What news or promise could make them back off?

Just Who I Was Looking For – Reaction: When a PC splits from the group, introduce a NPC related to their archetype or background, who intercepts the PC. They want to talk, but have reason to not want the other PCs to know about the meeting. They have an opportunity, request, or demand for the PC that the other characters might not like…

Where do they find the PC? Is this person connected to one of the factions? What are they asking for? Why don't they want the other PCs to know about this situation?

Rat's Nest Tavern

"My colleagues have an experiment in mind that requires a large delirium crystal. Smaller shards won't suffice. Unfortunately, such specimens are quite rare in the Outer City ruins. However, we've got a lead…"

A small chunk of the meteor broke off and crashed into the Rat's Nest Tavern in the Sprawl, utterly destroying most of the building. However, an intact delerium crystal was left behind. Unfortunately, a ratling colony has created a burrow under the taphouse basement and moved the meteorite into their warrens. The ratlings have grown bold enough to launch raids throughout the ruins and take several captives in the process.

Overview

In this adventure, the characters travel to the Rat's Nest Tavern to obtain a delerium crystal or rescue a captive prisoner. How the characters accomplish either is up to them: they can fight, sneak past, or trick the ratlings, but the creatures will viciously defend their lair by responding with ambushes and traps of their own.

Adventure Hooks

Good Prospects. (Amethyst Academy) River contacts the characters for a clandestine meeting. She wants them to retrieve a delerium crystal from the Rat's Nest.

A crystal of this size is normally worth about 2 sacks of gold, but she offers 2 sacks and a bag.

- River's intel is based on rumours the tavern was destroyed by a breakaway piece of the original meteor. Since her intel is based on speculation, she offers the characters a *minor potion of healing* each as an advance in the event that the characters turn up nothing.
- River cannot disclose the nature of the experiment*:*

> "Your continued discretion ensures continued employment."

Missing in Action. (Hooded Lanterns) Petra Lang approaches the characters in Emberwood Village. Her brother, Ansom Lang, was captured when ratlings ambushed them during a supply run last night. She needs the characters to rescue Ansom before it's too late. She offers 5 bags of gold as a reward for his safe return.

- Against orders to retreat, Petra tracked the ratlings to the Rat's Nest. She was driven off when the ratlings wounded her with a contaminated sling bullet. Petra explains that ratlings often keep prisoners to have a "fresh meal" later. She's positive Ansom is still alive.
- Petra warns the characters about the dangers of contamination. She can't help the characters personally as she's recovering from contamination herself. She advises them that if they get contaminated in the ruins, Flamekeeper Hanna in Emberwood Village can help them with her magic.
- Finally, she promises to put in a good word with the Lord Commander for the characters' help. However, she emphasizes this is a personal job - she's already risking insubordination:

> *"Amongst the Hooded Lanterns, our survival doctrine says we don't risk lives on 'futile' rescue attempts. We all knew the dangers when we signed up, but he's my brother."*

Interactions

For the most part, the ratlings in the burrow are hostile to trespassers of any sort. They know who lives in the burrow and who does not, and can recognize each other by scent. They lure intruders into traps or ambushes where the ratlings can use their numbers to their advantage. The ratlings are most active at night, when two-thirds leave the burrow on foraging raids. During the daylight hours, most ratlings are sleeping in their dens except for a few sentries.

The Rat Prince

Bully, only logical when it comes to food, repeats himself in conversation

Underborne Ratling (he/him)
A large and ferocious ratling who self-styles himself as the Rat Prince (see Appendix A). He rules this burrow because he's the biggest, strongest, and killed the last ratling who called themselves the Rat Prince.

Roleplaying: When speaking, he frequently repeats words three times for emphasis, "Yes yes yes". He believes once his colony has enough food, they will be able to grow large and multiply. Then all the other ratlings will bow down to him for sure!

Hope: Gather enough food so he and his colony can grow until he rules all the ratlings!
Fear: Losing power to another bigger, stronger ratling.

Treasure Hunter, *what signs of having killed other adventurers and faction agents does the Rat Prince carry with him?*

Squeaks the Seer

Braggart for the Rat God, cunning, deluded by delerium

Underborne Ratling (she/her)
Description: This albino ratling warlock of the rat god is the spiritual leader of the colony. She remains popular because she leads cannibalistic rituals in the name of the Rat God.

Roleplaying: Squeaks thinks she can talk to the Rat God through the delerium crystal, which she keeps in her lair. She loves to spin tall tales of the Rat God's power and cunning.

Hope: Pleasing the Rat God by collecting the shiny (delerium).
Fear: Losing the favor of the Rat God by letting the delerium stone be taken.**Missionary**, how can you tell that Squeaks is a false prophet and lying about her insights?

Befriending the Ratlings

In the original *Dungeons of Drakkenheim* campaign, the Rat Prince surrendered to the player characters. Using deception to convince the Rat Prince they were ghosts dispatched by the Rat God, the Rat Prince befriended the characters and became a recurring NPC. The player characters continued to protect and hide the ratlings, but once the garmyr were driven out of the city, nothing was holding back a growing ratling population. Left completely unchecked, their numbers swelled to gargantuan proportions that threatened to overtake the entire city!

Area Details

Scrag Lane

The Rat's Nest Tavern lies on the mud-slick and rubble-strewn Scrag Lane south of Shepherd's Way, nestled between ramshackle tenements and crumbling flats. The original tavern has been almost entirely obliterated, and the neighbouring buildings are heavily damaged. What remains are stone foundations piled with debris. The first-floor walls stand about chest high, a few supporting timbers splayed outward like a burst ribcage. The rooftop and upper levels have entirely collapsed into a mist-covered crater filled with rubble. The original tavern sign juts out obliquely from a building on the opposite side of the street. It is engraved with a smiling, obese rat laying on a plate of food.

Survivor*, what stories have you heard about the Rat's Nest Tavern? Do you have memories of this place from before the meteor?*
On a successful search of the environs, PCs can discover an entrance to the Drakkenheim sewers, slick with delerium sludge.

Taproom Ruins

Inside what remains of the tavern walls, the wooden floorboards of the ground level have almost entirely collapsed into a large gaping hole. Tumbled brick piles, ashen cinders, burned shingles, splintered wooden planks, support beams, fractured furniture, cracked mugs, broken glass, random bits of bone and cutlery are scattered everywhere.

[1] Cratered Basement

The stone walls of the basement are scorched and blackened. Rubble and debris surround a muddy crater fifteen feet wide and five feet deep. A faint glimmer of octarine light twinkles within. An earthen passage leads to the west.

PCs exploring the Taproom Ruins and Cratered Basement can make an Instinct Roll to evaluate the scene in the ruins and cratered basement.

- **Failure with Fear:** They are interrupted by a Ratling Pack returning from the hunt.
- **Failure with Hope:** They can mark a Stress to identify animal-like scratchings, gnaw marks, patches of coarse fur, muddy tracks, and rat droppings.
- **Success with Fear:** They learn information as Failure with Hope and see that the ratlings dragged something from this space, but they must mark a Stress from the terrible smell.
- **Success with Hope:** As Failure with Hope (no marking Stress), and see that the ratlings dragged something big from the crater not too long ago through a recently-breached wall.
- **Critical Success:** As Success with Hope but they also find 1d6 delerium slivers in the mud.

[2] Entrance Passage

This muddy passage is roughly eight feet wide. It tunnels steeply down ten feet before veering sharply left. It is trapped per the **Spring a Trap: Pit Trap** environment feature.

[3] Lookout's Burrow

The sound of soft rustling and chittering rats fills this muddy earthen den. Ratling Guttersnipes and a Ratling Pack are usually here on watch.

There is a pit trap here with a swarm of rats (see **Spring a Trap: Pit Trap**).

[4] Ratling Nests

The circular tunnels between areas are barely fix feet in diameter, forcing larger creatures to hunch or crawl. This tiny dugout cavities contains a cup-shaped nest made from long grasses, hay, mud, twigs, and leaves, and is lined with shredded bits of discarded cloth, fur scraps, bits of leather, paper, and small glimmering trinkets.

There is usually a Ratling Pack and one Guttersnipe in each area marked [4] - one group in the northernmost [4], another in the near-north [4], and a third in the southwest [4].

[5] Food Caches

Haphazardly splayed about this rancid-smelling den are all manner of recently scavenged dead animals, body parts, and other unsavory stores.

Hooded Lantern Captain Ansom Lang or another faction agent is held captive in one of these caches, injured and bound but able to move if they're freed. They promise a reward from their faction if rescued and escorted to a faction stronghold or a rendezvous point on the outskirts of the city.

[6] Idol of the Rat God

This chamber contains a bloated effigy of a horrifically obese demonic rat made from rubble, mud, and rat feces, set with two pieces of delerium for eyes. Offerings are scattered about the statue's feet — skulls, bone, daggers, bits of rotting meat, and smaller delerium fragments. Before it lies a blood-soaked altar made from a simple stone slab.

The eyes of the idol are delerium fragments, requiring a **Finesse Roll** to extract safely. On a failure, a PC must make an **Instinct Reaction Roll** to react fast enough to avoid the shards or gain a level of contamination.

[7] Gathering Den

The Rat Prince is often found here carousing with a Ratling Pack.

Ratlings flee to the sewers from here if they are wounded or cannot defend their lair.

[8] Seer's Den

In this spacious chamber is a large and sumptuous basket nest. Woven over the nest is a canvas made from stitched together scraps of fine cloth, twigs, and choice leaves. Before the nest is a rough stone plinth upon which is placed a hunk of silvery rock about a foot wide. A protruding delerium crystal is embedded in its surface.

Squeaks the Ratling Seer keeps her nest here.

The chunk of rock containing the delerium crystal weighs about fifty pounds.

RAT'S NEST TAVERN

Tier 2 Exploration

A subterranean ratling colony with twisting tunnels, muddy slopes, and no lighting.

Impulses: Draw in the curious, echo the past

Difficulty: 14
Potential Adversaries: Giant Rat Pack, Ratlings (any)

FEATURES

Darkened Corridors – Passive: There are no sources of light beyond the entrance passage, as the ratlings do not need it to navigate. Many action rolls made in the dark will gain disadvantage.

What smells and sounds become more prominent in the dark? Which way is the nearest source of light?

Ratling Treasures – Passive: PCs can find some stolen goods in the [5] Food Cache, or potentially elsewhere on a successful Instinct Roll, when defeating a group of ratlings, etc.

- 2 minor potions of healing
- A 1d12 result on the consumables table

What else might they PCs find? How has it been chewed, mangled, or mis-handled? How might they tell whether a potion is contaminated?

Get the Light! - Action: Move a Ratling within Close of a PC into Melee range and make an attack roll. On a success, instead of dealing damage, the ratling takes the light source and throws it into the mud, dousing it. If this was the PCs' only source of light, once per scene, gain 2 Fear.

What was the last thing you saw before the light went out? What senses to you rely on without being able to see?

Call the Pack – Reaction: When a Ratling marks major damage but is not defeated, **spend a Fear** to have them call out for aid. Activate a **Loop Countdown (3 Decreasing)**. When it triggers, introduce a Ratling Pack within Close to take the spotlight. When the countdown re-sets to 0 or by **spending a Fear** any time it triggers, introduce the Rat Prince to prove his might against the interlopers.

How many ratlings are in these warrens while others are out hunting? Where is the Rat Prince right now?

Spring a Trap - Reaction: When a PC moves into a new area or rolls a Failure with Fear on a roll to navigate the warrens, spend a number of Fear:

Pit Trap (1 Fear): The PC must make a Finesse Reaction Roll or slip on mud slide into a pit trap, taking 2d10 physical damage. Spend an additional Fear to reveal that there is a hostile Swarm of Rats in the pit. Climbing out requires an Agility Roll or assistance from an ally using rope and making an action roll.

- ***Ambush (2 Fear)***: Reveal 2 Ratling Guttersnipes and a Ratling Pack within Close distance. A Guttersnipe takes the spotlight immediately.

Where else might there be a muddy slide in the tunnels or a stand-alone spike trap? What have the Ratlings used to conceal their trap or ambush site?

Developments

Characters who successfully explore the Rat's Nest might trigger the following developments:

The Delerium Crystal

River upholds her end of the bargain faithfully. If the characters were swift and professional in their dealings with her, she gives them a single dose of aqua delerium as an additional reward. She encourages them to take a few days off to recuperate, promising to contact them shortly (in 1d6 days) with another job. On the other hand, River is much less impressed if the characters fail to recover the delerium crystal. She still offers to buy any found delerium from the characters, but decides to wait and reassess the characters' capabilities before offering them further work.

Characters who aren't already in contact with the Amethyst Academy still have a valuable find on their hands, which could put them in contact with any faction. The Hooded Lanterns know the delerium crystal is worth a small fortune, but they're happy to let the characters keep it as an extra reward for their efforts.

Ansom or Petra could suggest the characters sell the crystal in Emberwood Village to Fairweather Trades and Exports. Another NPC might suggest the characters ask around the village for contacts with the Amethyst Academy or the Queen's Men to sell the crystal to them. Alternatively, the characters might encounter a knight of the Silver Order, who encourages the characters to destroy the delerium. Finally, a pilgrim of the Falling Fire may claim the crystal has a holy purpose, and try to convince the characters to bring it to Lucretia Mathias at Saint Selina's Monastery as an offering.

Rescuing Ansom Lang

If Ansom Lang survives, he invites the characters to return with him to Shepherd's Gate. His comrades are thrilled at his safe return, and Lord Commander Elias Drexel takes note of the characters. He won't meet them personally just yet, but instead makes arrangements for Ansom or Petra to contact them for another mission within 7 (2d6) days.

Petra reminds the characters that their arrangement was a personal matter, and technically not official Hooded Lanterns business. As such, this mission alone won't earn the characters free passage through Shepherd's Gate. However, should the characters come to the gate in an emergency, the Hooded Lanterns will help them. In such an event, they'll overlook the tariffs "just this one time" and let them through.

If the characters fail to rescue Ansom, Petra believes them to be utterly incompetent. She hesitates to involve them further in Hooded Lanterns affairs, and bitterly mistrusts their capabilities in any future situations.

If Ansom dies, but the characters weren't yet working with the Hooded Lanterns, it's up to them whether or not they reveal her fate. Regardless, his comrades are shaken by his disappearance and death. In grief, the hard-hearted Lord Commander never speaks of him again. Petra presses on, but it feels like she's missing a part of himself.

Rattling Burrow

